The Theme on the Cover

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 3

Nib admired the planting pictures on the guide's cover. He opened a page of flowers while the wheel waited outside. Lark checked the operating-section tab. The picture was interesting, but it did not describe the mechanism whose timing needed investigation.

“These are splendid flowers,” Nib exclaimed. “This is the wheel’s section,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

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“We can reuse silent-e chunks in a longer word like inside,” Lark explained clearly. “Theme and these add a rarer e-and-final-e spelling for long e. Listen to those whole examples before reading them. We don't ask their familiar-looking letters to teach an unmodeled pattern by themselves.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try inside, theme, these. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read these on the prepared tab strip,” Lark invited gently. “Then follow the supplied operating-section heading to the wheel diagram.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **These notes tell the theme. The theme is the wheel.**

“What topic do the notes concern?” Lark asked gently. “Look at the sentence with theme.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The correct section opened to a drawing of the shaded inlet. The keeper pointed out the access route and asked the crew to inspect it at the next visit. Nib slipped a marker into that page. The flowers remained in the guide for another purpose; their beauty had not made them an explanation of the fault.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write theme beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded which section mattered and why. The heavy guide stayed closed in the dry shelter overnight. Next morning, a lamp would help the crew see the inlet without changing it.